EXECUTIVE REPORT

Project Manager Selection Process · Meridian Digital

Prepared for the decision maker · October 12, 2026

1. Executive summary

This report presents the results of a complete evaluation and selection process for the Project Manager role at Meridian Digital. 30 applicants were assessed across document/CV review, four psychometric instruments (cognitive ability, personality, integrity and vocational interests), two structured interviews and an assessment center. All evidence was consolidated into an interactive dashboard and a single weighted fit index (0-100) anchored to the role's target profile.

The process delivered measurable gains for the agency:

1. Higher expected fit than experience-based hiring: selecting the three candidates with the highest fit index (mean 90.2) instead of the three most experienced (mean 77.3) raises expected person-job fit by 12.9 points per hire (+17%).

2. Faster time-to-hire: a digitally delivered battery with automated scoring replaces a typically multi-week evaluation with a process completed in days.

3. Lower early-turnover risk: automated screening by the fit index flagged 8 of 30 applicants (27%) as clearly below the target profile, candidates who would likely have passed a CV-only screen.

Recommended shortlist: Fernanda Aguilar (91.7), Alejandra Perez (73.6) and Gabriela Perez (82.3) - three distinct profiles, with full evidence available in the dashboard.

2. Business problem

The Project Manager is the node between client expectations, creative and media teams, budgets and delivery dates at Meridian Digital. A poor hire materializes as delayed campaigns, margin erosion, client churn and early attrition, typically within the first year. Selection that relies on CV screening and unstructured interviews overweights experience and underweights the signals that most predict performance: structured personality, cognitive ability, integrity and vocational fit.

Meridian Digital asked for an evidence-based selection system: a target profile, standardized instruments, structured interviews plus an assessment center for the strongest applicants, and a transparent way to compare candidates on the same scale. This report presents the process, the results and the recommended decision.

3. Methodology

Target profile.

A competency model for the role was defined from the job description (docs/job_description_PM.docx), producing explicit target zones per construct: Conscientiousness P65-P95, Neuroticism P10-P40, integrity >= P65, cognitive ability >= P55.

Psychometric instruments.

• Cognitive ability - ICAR (Condon & Revelle, 2014): 16 items, four item types, IRT-based scoring.

• Personality - IPIP-NEO-120 (Johnson, 2014): 120 items, five domains and thirty facets.

• Integrity - Honesty-Humility scale of the HEXACO framework (Ashton, Lee & Goldberg, 2007): 10 items, 4 facets.

• Vocational interests - O*NET Interest Profiler (U.S. DOL): RIASEC congruence with an ESC-dominant profile.

Fit index.

Each construct maps to target-attainment (0-100). Overall fit = cognitive 20% + personality 35% + integrity 20% + interests 15% + CV 10%. Labels: High >= 72, Medium 55-72, Low < 55.

4. Technology

• Python 3.12 · pandas · numpy · scipy · matplotlib

• Streamlit + Plotly (interactive dashboard, monospace black/white/gray theme)

• python-docx + reportlab (this deliverable) · Git/GitHub

5. Results

The system evaluated 30 candidates. The fit index ranges from 42.8 to 91.7 (mean 68.4, SD 13.7); 14 candidates rank High (47%), 8 Medium, 8 Low.

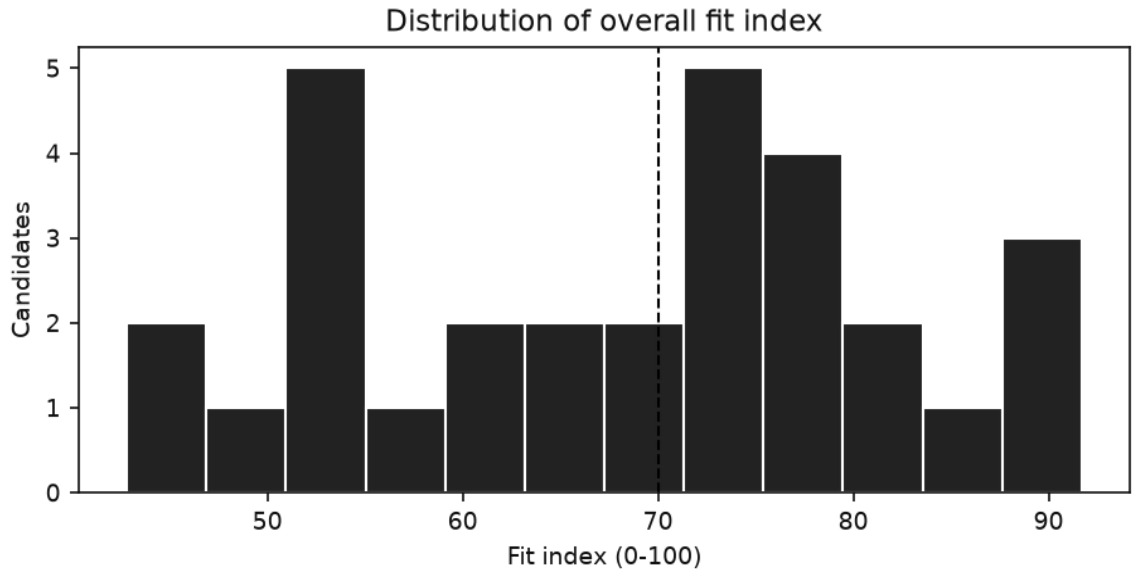


Figure 1. Distribution of the overall fit index.

Component-level analysis.

The five components are balanced and no single test dominates. Cognitive and personality signals carry the strongest weight, while interest congruence is naturally high in a pool that self-selects for the industry.

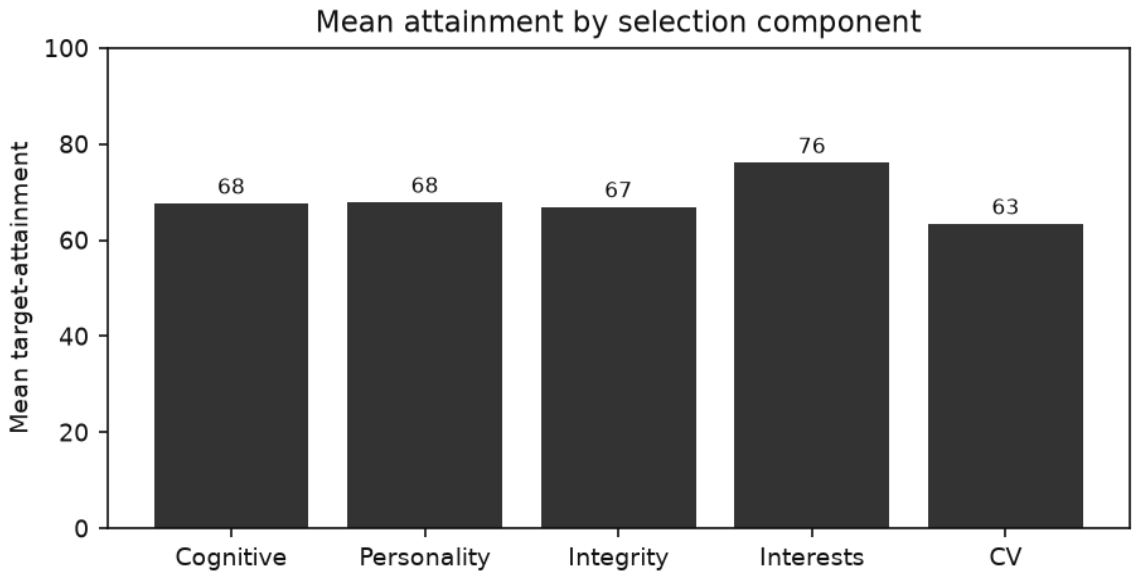


Figure 2. Mean target-attainment by selection component.

Component	Weight	Mean	r with fit
Cognitive ability (ICAR)	20%	67.7	0.72
Personality (IPIP-NEO-120)	35%	67.9	0.64
Integrity (Honesty-Humility)	20%	66.9	0.31
Vocational interests (O*NET)	15%	76.1	0.53
CV & documentation	10%	63.4	0.32

Key relationships.

Cognitive ability correlates most strongly with fit (r = 0.72); personality r = 0.64; integrity r = 0.31. CV/documentation alone (r = 0.32) and experience (r = 0.48) are weak predictors of the final recommendation.

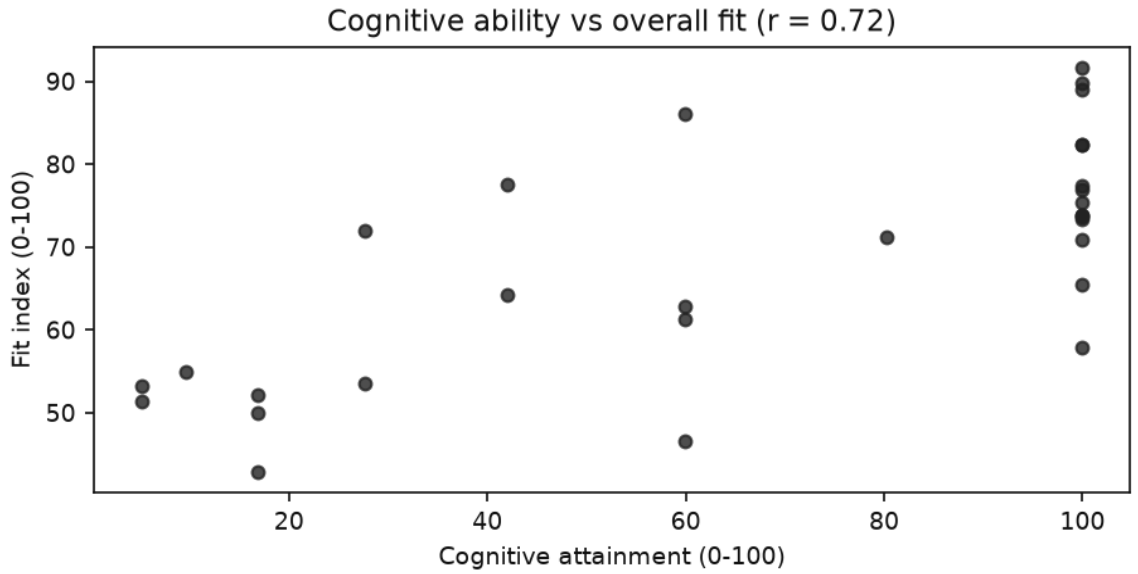


Figure 3. Cognitive attainment vs overall fit.

Proposed shortlist.

Selection angle	Candidate	Education	Fit	AC
First choice - best overall fit	Fernanda Aguilar (PM-013)	Communications · 8 yrs	91.7	2.7/5
Strongest behavioral profile	Alejandra Perez (PM-017)	Industrial Engineering · 6 yrs	73.6	3.6/5
Highest growth potential	Gabriela Perez (PM-023)	Software Engineering · 3 yrs	82.3	3.4/5

6. Conclusions and recommendations

• The fit index integrates the full evidence base into one auditable number; its range (42.8-91.7) confirms it discriminates among applicants.

• Structured cognitive and personality indicators drive the recommendation; experience alone is a weak proxy for person-job fit (r = 0.48).

• Adopt the fit-index workflow as the standard pre-offer gate for this role, and consider extending it to other agency positions.

• Recalibrate component weights and bands after six months of on-the-job performance data.

• Assign a named decision maker to review the shortlist in the dashboard before the final offer.